

Website Cost in India 2026: WordPress vs Shopify Pricing (Complete Breakdown)

How much does a website cost in India in 2026? With an agency like Vyaaptam, a small-business website costs roughly ₹9,999 to ₹39,999 to build, and larger custom projects are quoted separately. On top of the build, every site has running costs: a domain, hosting or a platform subscription, apps or plugins, and payment fees.

The confusing part is that WordPress and Shopify charge in completely different ways. WordPress is free software, so you pay for the build, hosting and domain. Shopify is a subscription, so you pay monthly, plus apps and transaction fees. This guide puts both side by side in rupees so you can budget with confidence.

Key takeaways

- Budget for two numbers: the **one-time build cost** and the **yearly or monthly running cost**.
- WordPress: free software, you pay for build, hosting and domain. Shopify: a monthly plan plus transaction fees and apps.
- Shopify Basic is about **₹1,499 a month** on annual billing, before 18% GST (mid-2026 pricing).
- Service businesses and blog-led sites usually fit WordPress best. Product stores that want a fast launch usually fit Shopify best.
- Vyaaptam packages: **₹9,999** (Silver), **₹19,999** (Gold) and **₹39,999** (Diamond).

How much does a website cost in India in 2026?

The build cost depends on the number of pages, whether you need an online store, and how much SEO, branding or app work is included. Here is how Vyaaptam's packages map to common needs:

Type of website	Starting price	Typical timeline	Usual platform
5-page business website	From ₹9,999 (Silver)	5–10 working days	WordPress
10+ pages, blog and payment gateway	From ₹19,999 (Gold)	2–4 weeks	Shopify or custom WordPress
Full presence: SEO pages, branding, basic mobile app	From ₹39,999 (Diamond)	2–4 weeks or more	WordPress, Shopify or React
Custom portal or complex web app	Quoted per project	Depends on scope	Laravel, React, Node.js and others

Freelancers and larger agencies price differently, so treat these as a reference point for an agency-built small-business site.

What does a website cost after launch?

The build is only part of the bill. Running costs are where WordPress and Shopify differ most:

Cost item	WordPress	Shopify
Software / platform	Free (open source)	Monthly subscription
Domain name	Yearly fee (.com or .in)	Yearly fee, or connect your own
Hosting	Separate hosting plan, paid yearly	Included in the plan
Extra features	Plugins (many free, some paid)	Apps (often monthly subscriptions)
Payments	Payment gateway fees	Gateway fees plus Shopify transaction fee
Security and updates	You or your agency handle updates and backups	Handled by Shopify

How much does Shopify cost in India in 2026?

Shopify publishes India pricing in rupees. These are the plans on annual billing, before 18% GST:

Plan	Price per month	Shopify transaction fee*	Best for
Starter	₹399	Higher than other plans	Selling through social media or links, not a full online store
Basic	₹1,499	About 2%	New stores and first-time sellers
Grow	₹5,599	About 1%	Stores with steady monthly sales
Advanced	₹22,680	About 0.5–0.6%	High-volume stores and larger teams
Plus	Enterprise pricing	Lowest	Large brands

**Charged on top of your payment gateway's fee, because Shopify Payments is not available in India as of mid-2026. Monthly billing costs roughly 25% more than annual billing. Prices reflect Shopify's published India rates in mid-2026 and can change, so confirm on Shopify's India pricing page.*

A worked example: what a small Shopify store really pays

Say a Basic-plan store sells ₹2,00,000 a month (illustrative numbers):

- Subscription: ₹1,499 + 18% GST ≈ **₹1,769**
- Shopify transaction fee: 2% of ₹2,00,000 = **₹4,000**

- Apps (assumed): ≈ ₹3,000
- **Total: about ₹8,800 a month**, before your payment gateway's own charges

The lesson: the plan price is often the smallest part of a Shopify bill. Always budget for GST, transaction fees and apps.

How much does a WordPress website cost in India?

WordPress itself costs nothing, so your budget goes to four things: the design and build, a domain, hosting, and any premium theme or plugins you need. Vyaaptam's WordPress builds start at ₹9,999 for a 5-page mobile-responsive site with basic SEO setup and WhatsApp chat.

One practical tip: ask your agency to register the domain and hosting **in your name** and list them as separate line items. That way you own your website assets and can move agencies without losing anything.

WordPress vs Shopify: which is cheaper?

Shopify is usually cheaper and faster to launch for a product store. WordPress is usually cheaper over time for service, content and blog-led websites. Here is the full comparison:

Factor	WordPress (with WooCommerce for stores)	Shopify
Upfront cost	Build cost + domain + hosting	Build or theme setup + first plan payment
Ongoing cost	Hosting, renewals, maintenance, paid plugins	Monthly plan, GST, transaction fees, apps
Best for	Service businesses, blogs, custom features	Product stores that want a quick launch
Ease of use	Moderate; more to manage	Easy; built-in tools
Design flexibility	Very high	High, within the theme system
SEO control	Very high	Good, with some URL structure limits
Who maintains it	You or your agency	Shopify handles hosting and security

Choose WordPress if you:

- run a service business, clinic, consultancy or coaching practice and need credibility pages, a blog and local SEO
- want full control over design, features and SEO
- prefer paying mostly one-time build costs instead of a monthly subscription

Choose Shopify if you:

- sell physical products and want checkout, inventory and shipping tools built in
- want to launch fast and avoid managing hosting and security
- are comfortable with a monthly plan plus transaction fees and apps

Which platform fits your business?

Business type	Best fit	Why
Clinic, CA, consultant, coaching institute	WordPress (Silver)	Needs trust-building pages, a blog and local SEO, not a shopping cart
D2C brand or product seller	Shopify (Basic to start)	Fast launch with built-in checkout and inventory
Content-led business or publisher	WordPress	Best blog and SEO control
Store needing custom checkout or unusual features	WordPress + WooCommerce	Maximum flexibility
Brand wanting site plus mobile app	Diamond or custom build	Combines website, app and branding

Hidden website costs Indian businesses forget

- **18% GST** on Shopify subscriptions and most agency invoices
- **Transaction and gateway fees** on every online sale
- **Paid apps and plugins** for reviews, loyalty, subscriptions or advanced analytics
- **Renewals:** domains and hosting are billed every year, and renewal prices can be higher than the first-year offer
- **Content and photography:** a site needs good copy and images to convert
- **Marketing:** a new website does not bring traffic on its own. Budget for SEO, Google Business Profile and ads
- **Maintenance:** updates, backups and security checks for WordPress sites

What should a website package include?

Before you sign, check that the package covers these basics:

- mobile-responsive design and fast loading
- SSL certificate, sitemap and basic on-page SEO (meta titles, descriptions, optimised images)
- Google Analytics 4 and Search Console setup
- WhatsApp chat or a clear contact form

- a defined support period after launch
- domain and hosting registered in your name

Vyaaptam website packages

Package	Price	What is included	Best for
Silver	₹9,999	5-page WordPress site Mobile responsive Basic SEO setup WhatsApp chat 1-month support	Local businesses and first websites
Gold	₹19,999	Shopify or custom WordPress 10+ pages plus blog Payment gateway On-page SEO 3-month support	Growing businesses and small online stores
Diamond	₹39,999	WordPress, Shopify or React SEO-optimised pages Basic Android/iOS app Branding and logo 6-month support	Brands that want a full digital presence

Custom quotes are available for larger projects. Website migration (WordPress to Shopify or the reverse) is handled with content transfer and domain redirection to protect SEO.

Frequently asked questions

How much does a website cost in India in 2026?

With an agency like Vyaaptam, a small-business website costs roughly ₹9,999 to ₹39,999 to build, depending on pages, e-commerce, SEO and app needs. Larger custom projects are quoted separately. Running costs such as domain, hosting or a Shopify subscription come on top.

Is Shopify cheaper than WordPress in India?

Shopify is often cheaper to launch and simpler to maintain, but it charges a monthly plan, transaction fees and paid apps. WordPress can be cheaper over the long run for service or content sites, because the software is free and you pay only for hosting, domain and upkeep.

How much does Shopify cost per month in India?

Shopify's Basic plan is about ₹1,499 a month on annual billing before 18% GST, Grow is about ₹5,599 and Advanced about ₹22,680. Monthly billing costs roughly 25% more. Check Shopify's India pricing page for current rates.

Is WordPress really free?

The WordPress software is free and open source. You still pay for a domain, hosting, any premium theme or plugins, and the design and development work, unless you build the site yourself.

Does Shopify charge transaction fees in India?

Yes. Shopify Payments is not available in India as of mid-2026, so stores use gateways like Razorpay, PayU or Cashfree. Shopify then charges its own transaction fee (about 2% on Basic) on top of the gateway's fee.

How long does it take to build a website?

A basic business website usually takes 5 to 10 working days. An e-commerce store or custom website typically takes 2 to 4 weeks, depending on how quickly content and approvals arrive.

Can I move from WordPress to Shopify without losing SEO?

Yes, if the migration is planned properly. That means transferring content, redesigning where needed, and setting up 301 redirects from old URLs to new ones so search rankings are preserved.